

Student Name

Date

Read Me File for Subjective Well-Being Exercise

Contents of the reproduction documentation

The contents of the reproduction documentation are illustrated in the directory hierarchy below.

SWBExercise/

```
|—TheReport.pdf
|—ReadMe.pdf
|—Data/
|   |—InputData/
|       |—pew_input.csv
|       |—wdi_input.csv
|   |—IntermediateData/
|       |—pew_intermediate.dta
|       |—wdi_intermediate.dta
|   |—AnalysisData/
|       |—analysis.dta
|—Scripts/
|   |—aio.do
|   |—ProcessingScripts/
|       |—pew_processing.do
|       |—wdi_processing.do
|       |—merging.do
|   |—AnalysisScripts/
|       |—analysis.do
|—Output/
|   |—Figures/
|       |—Figure1.gph
|       |—Figure2.gph
|       |—Figure3.gph
|   |—Tables/
|       |—Table1.rtf
```

Software and operating system

All computations for this exercise were performed with Stata 19, on a Windows 11 operating system.

One of the scripts uses a command from the user-written "asdoc" package. A command that installs asdoc is included in the script where it is needed (*analysis.do*).

Instructions for using this documentation to reproduce the exercise

1) Download or copy the **SWBExercise/** folder, and all of its contents, onto the computer you are working on.

Note: When you copy the **SWBExercise/** folder to your computer, be sure that the hierarchy of subfolders and files contained in it is not changed. The folder hierarchy on your computer should match the outline given above in this Read Me file.

2) Launch Stata, and set the working directory to the **SWBExercise /** folder.

Note: Throughout the entire process of reproducing the results of the exercise, Stata's working directory should remain set to the **SWBExercise/** folder. In all the scripts, commands that specify folder locations do so using relative directory paths that begin in the **SWBExercise/** folder.

3) Execute the *pew_processing.do* script.

This script:

- Reads the data in the *pew_input.csv* data file.
- Modifies the data to prepare it for merging with the WDI data.
- Saves the modified data in a file called *pew_intermediate.dta*, which is stored in **IntermediateData/**.

4) Execute the *wdi_processing.do* script.

This script:

- Reads the data in the *wdi_input.csv* data file.
- Modifies the data to prepare it for merging with the Pew data.
- Saves the modified data in a file called *wdi_intermediate.dta*, which is stored in **IntermediateData/**.

5) Execute the *merging.do* script.

This script:

- Opens the *pew_intermediate.dta* data file (which was created by the *pew_processing.do* script and saved in **IntermediateData/**)
- Merges, matching on *country*, the Pew intermediate data that was just opened with the WDI intermediate data in *wdi_intermediate.dta* (which was created by the *wdi_processing.do* script and saved in **IntermediateData/**)
- Keeps only observations for countries that appear in both the Pew intermediate data and the WDI intermediate data (i.e., keeps only the observations that match when the intermediate data files are merged)
- Saves the merged data in the **AnalysisData/** folder, in a file named *analysis.dta*.

6) Execute the *Analysis.do* script.

This script:

- Reads the data in the *analysis.dta* data file (which was created by the *merging.do* script and saved in **AnalysisData/**)
- Executes commands that generate the results presented in the report:
 - o A table of summary statistics of the variables *gdppc* and *meanswb*, saved in the **Tables/** folder, with the name *Table1.rtf*.
 - o Histograms of the variables *gdppc* and *meanswb*, saved in the **Figures/** folder, with the names *Figure1.gph* and *Figure2.gph*.
 - o A scatterplot of *meanswb* against *gdppc*, saved in the **Figures/** folder, with the name *Figure3.gph*.

Note: All the steps of data processing and analysis described above in steps 3 through 6 can be executed simply by executing the all-in-one script, *aio.do*, which executes the other scripts (three processing scripts and one analysis script) in the correct order.

Provided you first set Stata's working directory to the project folder (**SWBExercise/**), it is therefore possible to reproduce all the data processing and analysis required to generate the results for this exercise just by executing *aio.do*.